

BOMI COMMUNITY COLLEGE

School of Health Sciences

Fatorma Compound, Tubmanburg

Bomi County, Western Liberia

TOPIC: Personality Disorder

Course: Psychiatric Nursing II

Course Code:

Submitted To: MR. Kesselly R. Dorbor

(ASN, RN, BSN, MHC, Cand, MPH)

Submitted By:

1. Del J. Brown 701493

2. Hosanatu Sow 700972

DATE OF SUBMISSION

JUNE 26, 2026

Introduction

Personality disorders are a group of mental health conditions characterized by inflexible and unhealthy patterns of thinking, feeling, and behaving. These inner experiences and behaviors often differ from the expectations of the culture in which an individual lives.

People with personality disorders often have difficulty interacting with others and coping with everyday problems in socially acceptable ways. They usually believe that their behaviors and thought patterns are normal, even though they may differ significantly from those of others. As a result, they may experience challenges in social, educational, occupational, and family settings. These difficulties often contribute to isolation, anxiety, and depression.

Although the exact cause of personality disorders remains unknown, research suggests that both genetic and environmental factors, particularly childhood trauma, contribute to their development. Personality disorders commonly begin during adolescence or early adulthood, and treatment typically involves psychotherapy, medication when necessary, and supportive care.

Characteristics of Personality Disorders

Personality disorders are grouped into three major clusters based on similar characteristics.

Cluster A: Odd or Eccentric Disorders

- Paranoid Personality Disorder
- Schizoid Personality Disorder
- Schizotypal Personality Disorder

Individuals in this cluster often appear eccentric, socially withdrawn, and suspicious of others.

1. Paranoid Personality Disorder

Signs and Symptoms

- Very secretive and mistrustful of others
- Confiding in others is perceived as dangerous
- Hyper-alert for signs of danger or attack
- Argumentative behavior
- Rarely seek help or require hospitalization
- Avoid sharing emotions except anger
- Hold grudges for long periods
- Difficulty maintaining intimate relationships
- Cold and aloof interpersonal style
- Frequent jealousy of spouse or sexual partner

2. Schizoid Personality Disorder

Characteristics

- Prefer solitary activities
- Occupational difficulties in jobs requiring interpersonal interaction

- Prefer occupations involving social isolation
- Limited emotional expression
- Flat or blunted affect
- Poverty of thought
- Believe close relationships are unnecessary
- Few or no close friends
- Indifferent to praise or criticism

3. Schizotypal Personality Disorder

Characteristics

- Similar features to schizophrenia without meeting diagnostic criteria
- Odd speech that is vague or overly elaborate
- Prefer solitary lifestyles
- Occupational difficulties
- Constricted or inappropriate affect
- Paranoid ideas
- Suspiciousness
- Magical thinking
- Difficulty making decisions
- Fear intimacy and close relationships

Cluster B: Dramatic, Emotional, or Erratic Disorders

- Antisocial Personality Disorder
- Borderline Personality Disorder
- Histrionic Personality Disorder
- Narcissistic Personality Disorder

1. Antisocial Personality Disorder

Characteristics

- Manipulative behavior
- Lack of remorse
- Lying, stealing, fighting
- Failure to meet responsibilities
- Pathological lying
- Aggressive behavior
- Egocentric personality
- Exploitative relationships
- Impulsive sexual behavior
- Emotional, physical, and verbal abuse of others

2. Borderline Personality Disorder

Characteristics

- Emotional instability

- Impulsive behavior
- Self-destructive activities
- Suicide threats or attempts
- Self-mutilation
- Manipulative behavior
- Identity disturbance
- Unstable relationships
- Fear of abandonment
- More common among females

3. Histrionic Personality Disorder

Characteristics

- Constant attention-seeking
- Dramatic behavior
- Emotional exaggeration
- Easily influenced by others
- Sensitive to criticism
- Romantic fantasies
- Overly trusting

4. Narcissistic Personality Disorder

Characteristics

- Grandiosity
- Need for admiration
- Lack of empathy
- Perfectionism
- Rage when criticized
- Social exploitation
- Low self-esteem despite arrogance

Cluster C: Anxious or Fearful Disorders

- Avoidant Personality Disorder
- Dependent Personality Disorder
- Obsessive-Compulsive Personality Disorder

1. Avoidant Personality Disorder

Characteristics

- Feelings of inferiority
- Fear of criticism
- Social withdrawal
- Avoidance of interpersonal situations
- Low self-confidence
- Few close relationships

2. Dependent Personality Disorder

Characteristics

- Excessive dependence on others
- Difficulty making decisions
- Fear of rejection
- Fear of abandonment
- Lack of self-confidence
- Constant need for reassurance
- Passive behavior
- Desire for continuous companionship

3. Obsessive-Compulsive Personality Disorder

Characteristics

- Perfectionism
- Inflexibility
- Excessive orderliness
- Need for control
- Repetitive checking
- Difficulty compromising
- Emotional distance in relationships

Causative Factors of Personality Disorders

1. Biological Factors

- Genetic predisposition
- Brain dysfunction
- Low serotonin levels
- Exposure to toxic substances

2. Developmental Factors

- Childhood abuse
- Emotional neglect
- Physical abuse
- Sexual abuse
- Lack of secure attachment

3. Sociocultural Factors

- Cultural influences
- Family environment
- Discrimination
- Immigration experiences
- Language barriers

Precipitating Stressors

- Family instability
- Divorce
- Loss of loved ones
- Job loss
- Reduced self-esteem
- Difficulty establishing relationships

Nursing Interventions

The following nursing interventions are recommended:

1. Show acceptance of the person while separating the individual from inappropriate behaviors.
2. Provide a safe environment.
3. Set and maintain clear behavioral limits.
4. Explain and consistently enforce unit rules.
5. Encourage responsibility for personal behavior.
6. Discuss appropriate alternative behaviors.
7. Avoid favoritism.
8. Encourage expression of feelings.
9. Identify triggers for inappropriate behaviors.
10. Monitor for manipulative behaviors.
11. Communicate behavioral concerns with the healthcare team.
12. Reinforce positive behavioral changes.
13. Approach paranoid clients calmly and from the front.
14. Monitor medication compliance.
15. Encourage participation in therapeutic activities.
16. Assess for suicidal thoughts.
17. Develop a no-harm contract with clients who exhibit self-destructive behaviors.

Conclusion

Personality disorders are complex mental health conditions that significantly affect an individual's thoughts, emotions, behaviors, and relationships. They often develop during adolescence or early adulthood and may persist throughout life without appropriate treatment. Early recognition, accurate diagnosis, effective psychotherapy, medication when indicated, and supportive nursing care can greatly improve patient outcomes. Nurses play a critical role in providing a safe therapeutic environment, promoting healthy coping strategies, and encouraging positive behavioral changes. Through comprehensive assessment, consistent interventions, and multidisciplinary collaboration, individuals with personality disorders can achieve improved functioning and a better quality of life.

References

1. Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders, Fifth Edition, Text Revision (DSM-5-TR). American Psychiatric Association. Washington, DC: American Psychiatric Publishing; 2022.
2. Essentials of Psychiatric Mental Health Nursing. 9th ed. Philadelphia: F.A. Davis Company.
3. Psychiatric-Mental Health Nursing. 9th ed. Philadelphia: Wolters Kluwer.
4. World Health Organization>. *Mental Health: Fact Sheets and Clinical Resources*.
5. ICD-11 for Mortality and Morbidity Statistics. Geneva: World Health Organization.